

User could not link Telegram — assistant claimed a code was sent when none was

Incident report · TScopier assistant chat & worker auth · 2026-09-17

SEVERITY	Low	STATUS	Fixed — edge functions on prod
DATES	User created 2026-09-16 21:44 UTC; assistant chat 2026-09-17 13:41 UTC; fix 2026-09-17	AFFECTED	1 user — iman_90@web.de (e0d1844e-...3a10da)
COMPONENT	assistantKnowledge.ts , assistant-chat/index.ts	ROOT CAUSE	The assistant used an in-chat tool that sends nothing, then told the user a code had been sent

1. Executive summary (plain English)

A new user could not work out how to connect their Telegram account. They asked the in-app assistant for help, typing “i cant add my telegram”. The assistant opened a phone-number box inside the chat and then told the user that a code had already been sent to their Telegram. **No code was ever sent.** Nothing had been sent to Telegram at all — the assistant simply opened an empty input box and then described it incorrectly.

The user waited, said “i didnt recieve anything”, was told to try again, and eventually gave up and was passed to live chat support. They never entered a phone number, so the real linking process never started. We fixed the assistant so it now sends the user to the Channels page and tells them to enter their phone number there — the same form that already works elsewhere in the app. We also added record-keeping so we can see every Telegram linking attempt in the database instead of having to guess.

2. Issue encountered

- User reported “i cant add my telegram” through the in-app assistant at 2026-09-17 13:41 UTC.
- The assistant called the start_telegram_link tool, which only opens a client-side phone-input card. It does **not** contact the worker or the Telegram API.
- The assistant then told the user “a code has been sent to Telegram”, which was false.
- The user waited for a code that was never sent, got frustrated, and was escalated to support.
- No send_code was ever invoked. There was no server-side trace of the attempt at all.

3. Affected user(s)

USER (EMAIL)	SUPABASE ID	PLAN	CREATED (UTC)	TELEGRAM SESSION	TELEGRAM CLAIM	SIGNALS / TRADES
iman_90@web.de	e0d1844e-...3a10da	Advanced (trialing)	2026-09-16 21:44	none	none	none

No trades were affected — the copier never ran for this user. This incident is only about the Telegram linking experience and the misleading assistant message.

4. Root cause

- The assistant was instructed to prefer the wrong tool.** The system prompt (assistantKnowledge.ts) told the assistant to “Prefer start_telegram_link (in-chat phone + OTP secure cards)” for Telegram linking.
- That tool does not send anything.** start_telegram_link in assistant-chat/index.ts returns { queued: true } and a pending client action that opens AssistantTelegramLinkCard . It makes no server call.
- The tool result gave the model no guidance.** Because the result was just { queued: true } , the model invented the plausible-sounding but false statement that a code had been sent.
- There was no audit trail.** Client-side tool calls were not recorded anywhere, so the only evidence of the attempt was the chat transcript itself.

5. The fix

- assistantKnowledge.ts — the “Link Telegram” instruction now tells the assistant to navigate to /channels and direct the user to the Telegram connection form at the top of that page. Behavior rule #4 no longer recommends start_telegram_link , and the telegram_link feature topic and page descriptions were updated to match.
- assistant-chat/index.ts — the start_telegram_link tool result now carries an explicit hint: the card is empty, no code has been sent, and the user must enter their phone number first. This prevents the model from claiming a code was sent.
- Observability added** — Telegram linking is now recorded in listener_events :
 - assistant_tool_call — every client-side assistant tool call (navigate, start_telegram_link, open_live_chat, ...)
 - telegram_link_attempt — when send_code or verify_code is called
 - telegram_link_success — when finalizeAuth completes
 - telegram_link_failed — with the step and error at every worker failure point

6. Files changed

- supabase/functions/_shared/assistantKnowledge.ts — prompt now routes to /channels .
- supabase/functions/assistant-chat/index.ts — tool hint no longer implies a code was sent; client-side tool calls logged.
- supabase/functions/telegram-auth/index.ts — logs telegram_link_attempt on send_code / verify_code.
- supabase/functions/_shared/listenerEvents.ts — **new** shared helper for writing listener_events from edge functions.
- worker/src/authService.ts — logs telegram_link_failed at each failure point and telegram_link_success on finalize.
- worker/src/listenerEvents.ts — new telegram_link_* event types plus failure/success helpers.

7. Verification

- Confirmed against production DB: assistant_threads holds the transcript; telegram_sessions , telegram_auth_pending , telegram_account_claims , copier_listener_health , broker_accounts , and signals are all empty for this user.
- Confirmed in Railway logs across all worker services: no send_code , verify_code , or finalize_auth events for this user.
- Worker typecheck (npx tsc --noEmit) passes.
- Subagent code review: PASS_WITH_NOTES. The one HIGH finding (the telegram_link_success log was unreachable because finalize is not a proxied route) was fixed by moving the success log into the worker’s finalizeAuth . The duplicate-failure-log finding was fixed by removing the edge function’s copy and keeping the worker as the single source.

8. Deployment status

- Edge functions** (assistant-chat , telegram-auth): deployed to **production** (sxkpcovbyaficvtkpsdo), **staging** (axdcledcyhyvzrnfkwat), and the Migration preview branch

(`supmsgcubipmmowrzoub`).

- **Worker:** deployed to **staging** via Railway (commit `0af6685b` , SUCCESS on both Listener and Trade). Not yet on the production worker.
- **Git:** pushed to `origin/staging` and `origin/main` (`5453dbd4`), and to `upstream/staging` (`0af6685b`).

On production today the assistant now routes users to `/channels` and no longer claims a code was sent, and `assistant_tool_call / telegram_link_attempt` rows are written to `listener_events` . The worker-side `telegram_link_failed / telegram_link_success` rows will only appear once the worker fix reaches the production worker.

9. Follow-ups

- Deploy the worker fix to the production worker so failure/success rows are recorded there too.
- Watch `listener_events` for `telegram_link_failed` rows to catch future linking problems early.
- Consider surfacing a user-visible “we couldn’t start your Telegram login” message rather than relying on the assistant’s wording alone.